



The Gulf Coast

CROWNING THE GULF OF MEXICO, this region (which

overlaps slightly with that of the Southern states) includes Florida, Alabama, Mississippi, and Louisiana. Here, the Gulf itself—and the waterways connected to it—dominate many aspects of culture and industry, from local foods and festivals to water sports, fishing, and tourism.

MIAMI STYLE

Surrounded by the heavy-duty glitz of Miami, South Beach is famous for its multicolored Art Deco buildings, now immaculately restored to their original condition. The pink-and-chrome perfection of a classic 1950s car perfectly matches the hotel's style, if not its period.



CALLE OCHO CARNIVAL

Miami's vast Cuban population is centered around Eighth Street. Their annual festival, the biggest Latino celebration in the US, is called *Calle Ocho*—Eighth Street in Spanish.



WALT DISNEY WORLD

This huge theme park near Orlando is one of the world's most profitable tourist destinations.

Florida's government has given Disney the right to enforce laws with its own security force.

The inviting beaches that line Alabama's coast are seldom overcrowded.

